5.3.1.3 Warping

Warping is the process of winding the sized warp yarns on the warp beam which will be placed over the loom. The warp beam is located at the back of the loom and holds the lengthwise yarns. It controls and releases the warp yarns as the weaving process is carried on. The warp ends are threaded through the heddles held by the harness. Every basic loom has a minimum of 2 heddles. The number of heddles in a loom varies from 2 to 12 for basic weaves, but for fancy weaves the number increases upto 32. The heddles help in the movement of warp yarn to form the shed, through which the shuttle carries the filling yarns. Once the filling yarn is passed through then reed is pushed to put the filling yarn in its place (Figure 5.10).

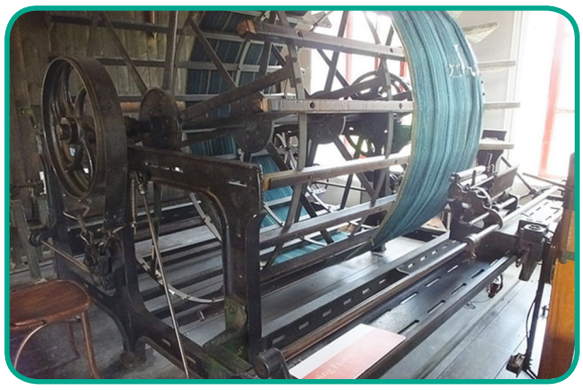


Figure 5.10 Warping

5.3.1.4 Fabric Making

The interlacing of warp and weft yarns results in woven fabric making. This is done on a loom through four main processes. They are shedding, picking, beating up and taking up and letting off processes.

- Shedding can be described as raising the specific warp yarns by the hard movement of the heddles; to form a 'V' shaped gap known as shed for the weft yarns to interlace through.
- Picking is the processing of interlacing/passing the filling yarn (weft) through the shed formed from right to left (Figure5.11).

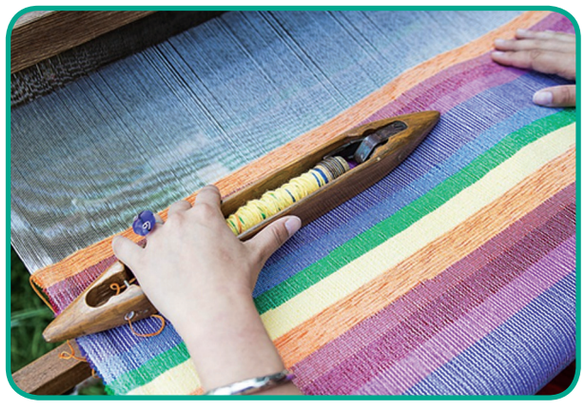


Figure 5.11 Picking

- Beating up is also known as battening. This is the process of pushing the filling yarn (weft) firmly into its place by the movement of the reed. Beating arranges the filling yarns parallel to each other very closely to create a woven structure.
- Taking up and letting off is the process of winding up woven cloth into the cloth beam and releasing more warp yarns from the warp beam for weaving.

5.3.2 Terms Used in Woven Fabrics

The common terms used while weaving are given below :

5.3.2.1 Selvedges

Selvedges are the lengthwise edges which run on both sides of the fabric. They are usually 0.5 to 1.5 cm broad. Selvedges prevent the fabric from raveling. It is strong with more number of warp yarns.

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